Signé par Em

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COLLECTION

INVESTORS

Short-Term Rentals (Airbnb)

What is legal
in Quebec.

2026 EDITION

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Important notice

This guide is provided for informational and educational purposes only. It presents general information about real estate in Quebec and does not constitute personalized real estate, legal, tax or financial advice. Every real estate situation is different, and you should consult the appropriate professionals before making a decision about a transaction.

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Short-Term Rentals and Airbnb

What is legal in Quebec before you get into short-term rentals

Short-term rental (Airbnb type) is a dream due to its potential income, but it is strongly regulated in Quebec - and the rules are tightening. Before buying or converting a home, you must understand the legal framework, otherwise you risk fines and blockages.

This guide takes stock of the required authorizations, municipal zoning, co-ownership rules and taxation - without ever assuming that “it works”.

2026 edition note: regulations are evolving rapidly; always validate the rules in force at the time of your project. Informational content, not legal advice. Each chapter ends with a lined “My Notes” page.

Short-term rental appeals with its income, but it is very regulated and full of pitfalls. This guide covers the provincial framework, municipal zoning (often decisive), co-ownership rules, real profitability and good operating practices.

The common thread: check that you have the right to operate BEFORE dreaming of income.

CHAPTER

The provincial framework: recording and display

> *Understand basic obligations.*

In Quebec, the offer of short-term tourist accommodation is regulated: it generally requires registration and the display of a number on advertisements, as well as compliance with security and tourist tax rules. Platforms and authorities have strengthened controls.

Renting without the required authorizations exposes you to significant fines. “I do it discreetly” is not a viable strategy.

In Quebec, short-term tourist accommodation is regulated: registration, number to display, and tax obligations. Operating without complying exposes you to significant fines. The first step is not to decorate the ad, but to verify that you have the right to operate, and how.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Don't be fooled by stories about people who "rent and do nothing." Controls have become tougher and fines are heavy. Assume that you have to be in good standing, period.*

CHAPTER

Municipal zoning: the deciding factor

> *Check if short term is even allowed at the address.*

Beyond provincial rules, each municipality (and district) sets its zoning: short-term rental is only permitted in certain zones, sometimes only for a primary residence, often prohibited elsewhere. It is THE factor that determines if your project is possible.

- Check the precise zoning of the targeted address BEFORE purchasing.
- Distinguish main residence vs dedicated accommodation (the rules differ).
- Some cities strongly limit or prohibit short-term travel.

Municipal zoning is the deciding factor: beyond provincial rules, each city (and often each sector) authorizes or prohibits short term. An address can be perfect on paper and completely prohibited in the short term. Check the zoning BEFORE buying with Airbnb.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Check the zoning of the EXACT address before purchasing for an Airbnb. A perfectly profitable project on paper is worth zero if the short term is prohibited at this address.*

CHAPTER

Co-ownership and building regulations

> *Don't forget the "co-ownership" layer.*

In a condo, even if the city and province permitted it, the declaration of co-ownership may prohibit or limit short-term rentals. Many co-ownerships explicitly prohibit it to preserve the tranquility and security of the building.

So check three layers: provincial, municipal (zoning) AND co-ownership. It only takes one ban to block the project.

In co-ownership, an added layer: even if the city and the province allow it, the declaration of co-ownership may prohibit short-term rental. Many buildings ban it. Read the declaration and the rules - failing to do so could result in union action.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *The short term must be permitted at THREE levels: province, city and co-ownership. One ban is enough to block everything - check all three before committing.*

CHAPTER

Real profitability and risks

> *Evaluate the short term like a real business.*

- Variable income (seasonality, occupancy rate) vs. high expenses (cleaning, management, furniture, wear and tear).
- Intensive management: it's a job, not a passive income.
- Regulatory risk: rules can change and reduce, or even prohibit, the activity.
- Compare honestly with what a traditional long-term rental would bring in.

The short term can be profitable, but it is more demanding and riskier than it seems. Go into it knowingly.

Evaluate the short term like a real business: variable income (seasonality, occupancy rate) vs. high expenses (cleaning, management, furniture, platforms, specific insurance). The profitability displayed quickly disappears if we neglect these costs and the active management required by this model.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Always compare short term to a good long term rental, taking into account labor and regulatory risk. Often, the long term offers a better peace of mind/yield ratio.*

CHAPTER

Operating well: taxation, insurance, management

> *Operate without unpleasant surprises.*

Once short-term rental is authorized, it still needs to be**operate correctly** :

- **Taxation** : income is taxable and certain taxes may apply.
- **Insurance** : a policy suitable for short-term rentals (a traditional home may not cover it).
- **Management** : reception, cleaning, maintenance, management of reviews.
- **Neighborhood** : noise and compliance with the rules to avoid complaints.

The profitability shown quickly disappears if we neglect these very real costs and obligations.

Once authorized, operate correctly: taxation (taxable income, applicable taxes), insurance adapted to the short term (a traditional home policy often does not cover), management (reception, cleaning, notices) and respect for the neighborhood. An uncovered loss can wipe out years of income.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Check that your insurance really covers short-term rentals: many home policies do not do this. An uncovered loss can wipe out years of income in one go.*

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

> *Your next steps, concretely.*

This week

1. Check the zoning of the address and municipal rules.
2. Check the declaration of co-ownership if applicable.

Within 30 days

1. Confirm registration and tax obligations.
2. Honestly compare short term vs long term.

Then

1. Only launch if the three levels allow it and the figures hold.

Before I start

1. Check municipal zoning, provincial rules and, in condos, the declaration.
2. Build a realistic budget and take out insurance adapted to the short term.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Registration: authorization required for short-term tourist accommodation.
- Zoning: municipal rules determining where the short term is permitted.
- Main residence vs dedicated accommodation: often different regimes.
- Declaration of co-ownership: may prohibit short-term condo ownership.
- Regulatory risk: change in rules that could limit activity.

- Registration: registration and number required for tourist accommodation.
- Zoning: municipal rule determining whether short term is permitted at the address.
- Declaration of co-ownership: may prohibit short-term rental in condos.
- Occupancy rate: proportion of nights rented, key to profitability.
- Short-term insurance: specific coverage, distinct from traditional housing.

GO FURTHER

Quiz - test yourself

1. Short term rental in Quebec is:

A) Free everywhere

B) Strongly regulated (registration, display, taxation)

C) Banned everywhere

D) Without rule

2. The deciding factor of feasibility is often:

A) Color

B) Municipal zoning of the address

C) The price

D) The neighbor

3. In a condo, the short term can be:

A) Always allowed

B) Prohibited by the declaration of co-ownership

C) Mandatory

D) Without rule

4. How many levels should the short term allow?

A) Only one

B) Three (province, city, condominium)

C) None

D) Five

5. Renting without authorization exposes you to:

A) Nothing

B) Significant fines

C) A bonus

D) A gift

6. The short term is:

A) 100% passive income

B) Intensive management, like a business

C) Without charges

D) Risk-free

7. Regulatory risk means:

A) No development

B) Rules can change and limit activity

C) A guarantee

D) Nothing

8. Before buying for the short term, you must:

A) Trust rumors

B) Check the exact zoning of the address

C) Ignore the city

D) Improvise

Answers

1. B - Strict provincial framework (chap. 1).

2. B - Zoning determines whether this is permitted (chap. 2).

3. B - Co-ownership is a 3rd layer (chap. 3).

4. B - A ban is enough to block (chap. 3).

5. B - Controls have tightened (chap. 1).

6. B - Household, management, usury (chap. 4).

7. B - To be included in the decision (chap. 4).

8. B - The exact address is decisive (chap. 2).

Make informed decisions. Choose with confidence. Move forward without regret.

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